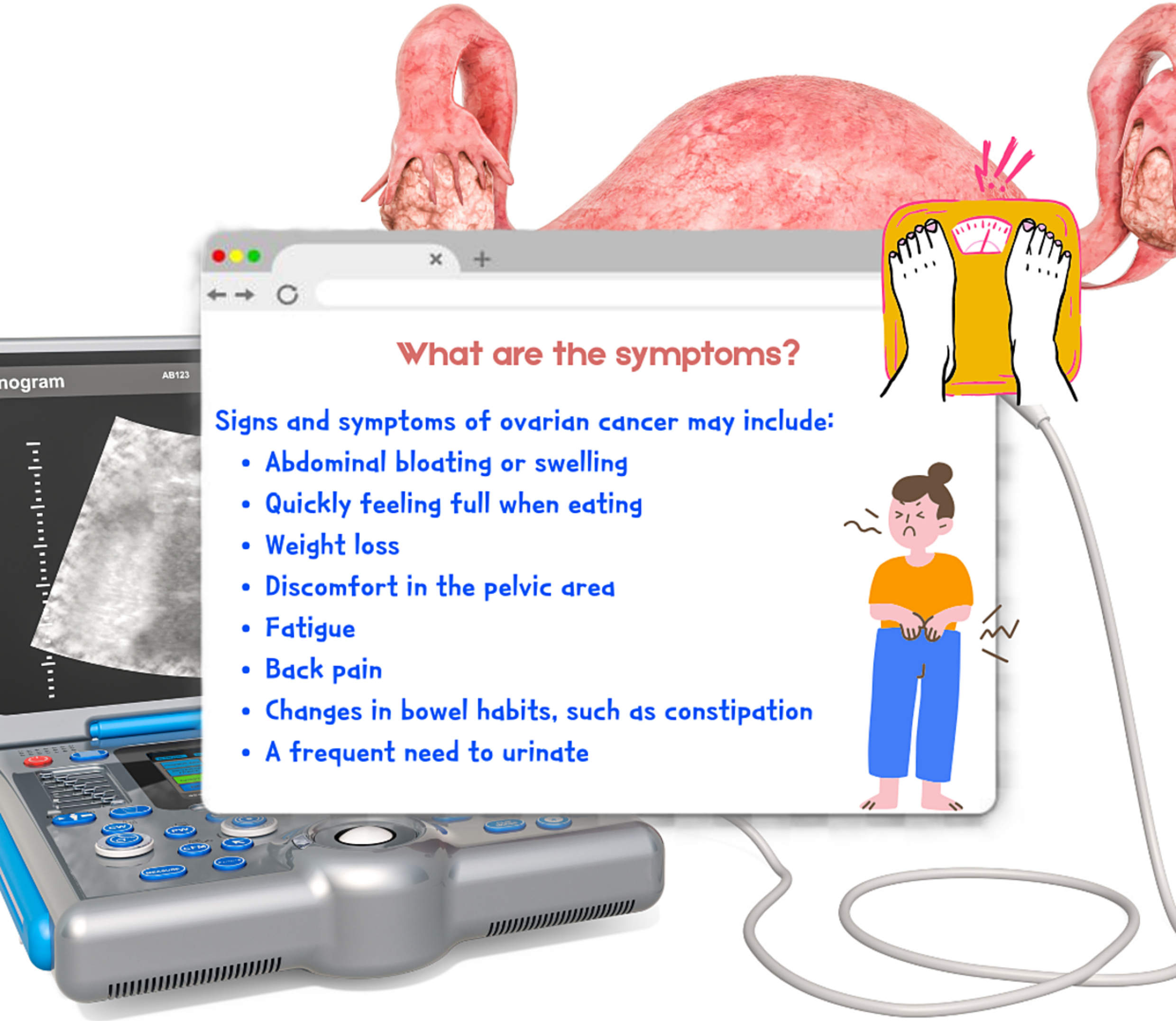
WHAT IS OVARIAN CANCER



What is ovarian cancer?

Ovarian cancer is a growth of cells that forms in the ovaries. The cells multiply quickly and can invade and destroy healthy body tissue. The female reproductive system contains two ovaries, one on each side of the uterus. The ovaries — each about the size of an almond — produce eggs (ova) as well as the hormones estrogen and progesterone. Ovarian cancer treatment usually involves surgery and chemotherapy.



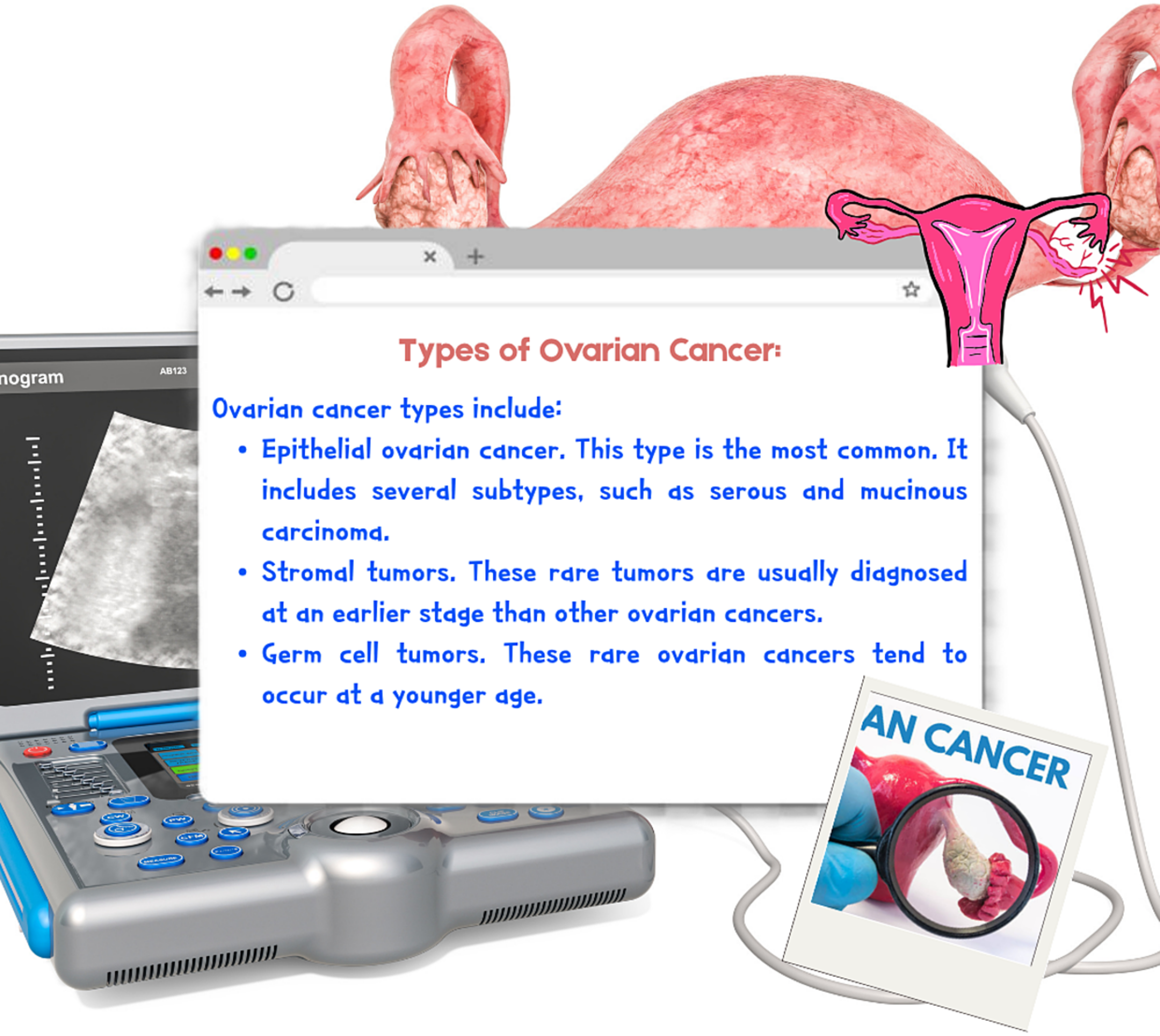
What are the symptoms?

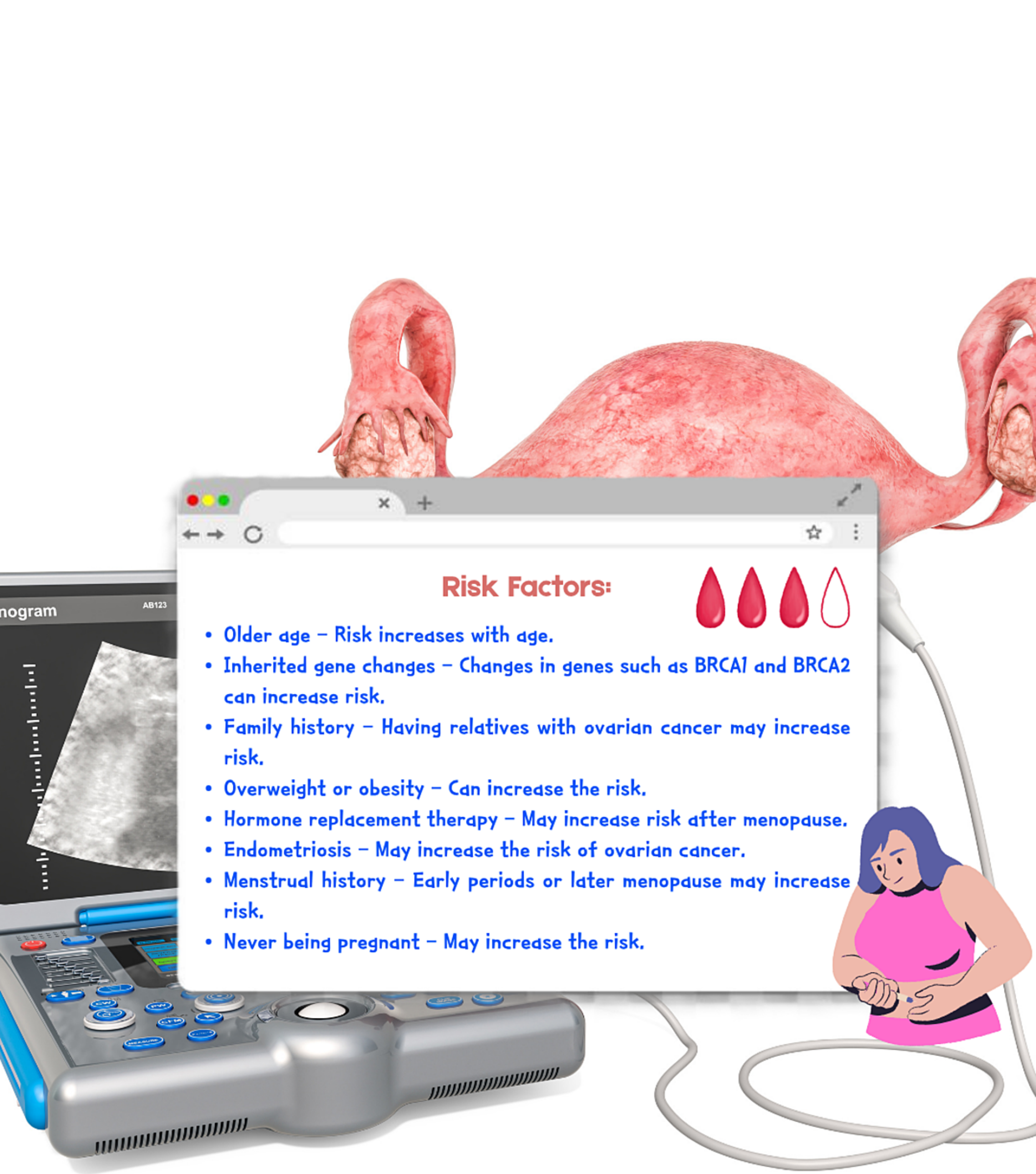
Signs and symptoms of ovarian cancer may include:

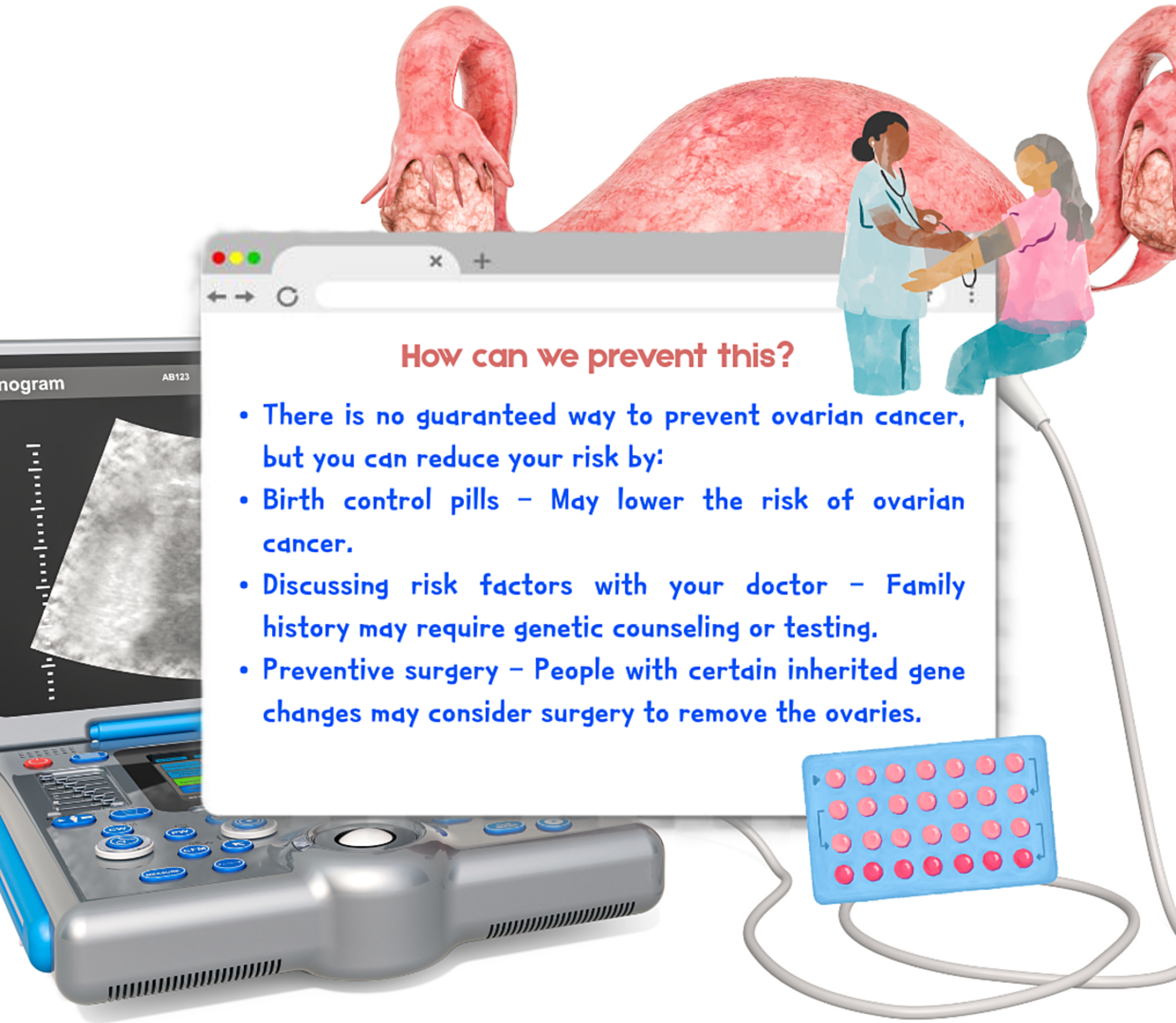
- Abdominal bloating or swelling
- Quickly feeling full when eating
- Weight loss
- Discomfort in the pelvic area
- Fatigue
- Back pain
- Changes in bowel habits, such as constipation
- A frequent need to urinate

What are the causes?

It's not clear what causes ovarian cancer, though doctors have identified things that can increase the risk of the disease. Doctors assume it occurs when DNA mutations cause cells in or near the ovaries to grow and multiply uncontrollably, forming tumours. These cancer cells can invade nearby tissues and spread to other parts of the body.


Types of Ovarian Cancer:
Ovarian cancer types include:
• Epithelial ovarian cancer. This type is the most common. It includes several subtypes, such as serous and mucinous carcinoma.
• Stromal tumors. These rare tumors are usually diagnosed at an earlier stage than other ovarian cancers.
• Germ cell tumors. These rare ovarian cancers tend to occur at a younger age.
AN CANCER


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Risk Factors:
• Older age – Risk increases with age.
• Inherited gene changes – Changes in genes such as BRCA1 and BRCA2 can increase risk.
• Family history – Having relatives with ovarian cancer may increase risk.
• Overweight or obesity – Can increase the risk.
• Hormone replacement therapy – May increase risk after menopause.
• Endometriosis – May increase the risk of ovarian cancer.
• Menstrual history – Early periods or later menopause may increase risk.
• Never being pregnant – May increase the risk.


How can we prevent this?
• There is no guaranteed way to prevent ovarian cancer, but you can reduce your risk by:
• Birth control pills – May lower the risk of ovarian cancer.
• Discussing risk factors with your doctor – Family history may require genetic counseling or testing.
• Preventive surgery – People with certain inherited gene changes may consider surgery to remove the ovaries.

When to see a doctor?

See your doctor if you experience persistent or unusual symptoms, especially:

- Ongoing bloating or abdominal pain
- Pelvic pain or pressure
- Changes in bowel or bladder habits
- Feeling full quickly or difficulty eating
- Unusual vaginal bleeding
- Symptoms that do not go away or worsen



Early medical evaluation can help identify the cause of these symptoms.